M.U.L.E. Cheat Sheet

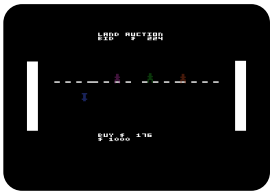
The FujiNet Multiplayer Edition

Atari 2600

Atari 2600 VCS



2. Land Grant



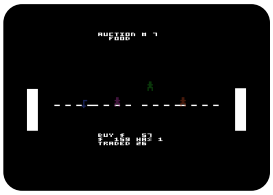
3. Bidding



4. In Town



5. Production



7. Trading

Controls

Everything is done with a direction and **the button**.

Control	What it does
Joystick	Walk; choose; move your auction line; declare (up sells, down buys)
FIRE	Start, join and ready; claim a plot; begin your turn; install, sample, catch the Wampus; collude; sit out a declaration
SELECT	End your development turn
RESET held for a second	Leave the table
Left difficulty switch at A	Sound off

Getting In

- **Start:** pick **M.U.L.E.** and the room **Planet IRATA** in the FujiNet Lobby, or mount tnfs://irata.online/mule/atari-2600/mule2600.bin and give your name and a table.
- **In the room:** left and right choose your species, and the button says you're ready. The game starts 31 seconds after the last person joins, or 6 seconds once everyone is ready. The computer plays every empty seat.
- **RESET (hold it for a second)** leaves. During a game it asks first, and the computer takes your seat.

A Month on Irata

1. **Summary** Everyone's money, land and goods, best first. Press the button when you've read it.
2. **Land Grant** One free plot a month. A square steps across the map. Press the button when it's over the plot you want.
3. **Land Auction** Some months only. Push up to bid, $4 a step. Let go and you drift back down.
4. **Development** Your turn. Press the button to start. The more Food you have, the longer it lasts. SELECT ends it early.
5. **Production** The M.U.L.E.s work. Food is eaten, Energy is used, and some of what's left spoils.
6. **Colony Event** Pests, pirates, acid rain, planetquakes. Most months, something hits the whole colony.
7. **Auctions** Smithore, Crystite, Food, then Energy. Push up to be a **Seller**, down to be a **Buyer**, or press FIRE to sit it out. Sellers walk down, Buyers walk up, and goods change hands where they meet. The store sells at the top and buys at the bottom.

On Your Turn

Corral	Buy a M.U.L.E. Walk it back in for a refund (not the outfit).
Outfitters	Fit it out for Food, Energy, Smithore or Crystite.
Your plot	Press the button to install it, or to swap it for the one there.
Assay Office	Press the button on a plot (no M.U.L.E. in tow) to take a sample, then bring it here.
Land Office	Then press the button on your plot to sell it at the next auction.
Pub	Ends your turn and pays: the more time left, the more it pays.
Wampus	Flashes in the mountains. Walk up with no M.U.L.E. and press the button.

Watch Out

- A M.U.L.E. **runs away** on land that isn't yours, without an outfit, or when your time runs out.
- Smithore and Crystite M.U.L.E.s can't work on the river. Nothing goes in town.
- Every M.U.L.E. that isn't making Energy uses 1 Energy a month. For each unit you're short, one plot makes nothing.
- Half of leftover Food and a quarter of leftover Energy spoil. You can hold at most 50 Smithore and 50 Crystite.
- You can't sell Food or Energy below your **critical level** (the line on the status bars).
- If the colony runs out of **Food or Energy**, it fails at once and nobody wins.
- **Collusion:** two players who press the button at nearly the same moment in an auction trade only with each other.

The Land

Land	Food	Energy	Smithore	Crystite
Plains	2	3	1	deposit
River	4	2	–	–
Mountains (one)	1	1	2	deposit
Mountains (two)	1	1	3	deposit
Mountains (three)	1	1	4	deposit
Town	–	–	–	–

The Store

	Food	Energy	Smithore	Crystite	M.U.L.E.
Outfit	$25	$50	$75	$100	–
Opening price	$30	$25	$50	$100	$100
Lowest price	$30	$25	$20	$50	–

Bonuses

- **Three of a kind:** for every three plots you own that make the same good, each makes 1 more.
- **Neighbours:** a plot makes 1 more if a plot of yours beside it (not diagonally) makes the same good.
- No plot makes more than 8.

Month by Month

Months	1–3	4–7	8–11	12
Food for a full turn	3	4	5	5
Event base amount	$25	$50	$75	$100
Wampus reward	$100	$200	$300	$400
Pub base winnings	$50	$100	$150	$200

The Colonists

Flapper $1,600 with 61-second turns; **the other six** $1,000 with 47-second turns; **Humanoid** $600 with 34-second turns; the **computer** (Mechtron) $1,200. Everyone starts with 4 Food and 2 Energy.

Winning

Money, plus **$500 a plot** (a plot with a M.U.L.E. adds its outfit price plus $35), plus your **goods** at the store's price. The richest colonist is the **FIRST FOUNDER**. The colony is rated on everyone's totals together:

under $20,000 **failed** · $20,000 **failed** · $40,000 **barely survived** · $60,000 **a success** · $80,000 **a great success** · $100,000 **a tremendous success** · $120,000 or more **a phenomenal success**

Tips from the Old Hands

- Food by the river, Smithore on the mountains, Energy on the plains.
- Grow your own Food early, or your turns get too short to do anything else.
- Put the same good side by side, and on three plots or more.
- Smithore is the bottleneck: no Smithore for the store, no new M.U.L.E.s.
- Assay before you dig. A High Crystite deposit is a winning ticket.

M.U.L.E. was designed by Ozark Softscape and published by Electronic Arts in 1983. Its pictures are converted from the 1983 Atari disk and remain the property of their owners.